

Samsung is Numero Uno in smartphones

It has been a battle royal for the giant smartphone rivals all this while. Six months after losing the top position in the smartphone market to Apple, Samsung regained leadership in the second quarter this year, as its sales rose 5 per cent to 36 million units, up from 34 million in the first quarter. Meanwhile, Apple suffered a 26 per cent decline in shipments to 26 million units, down from 35 million in the first quarter. Samsung's modest increase was propelled by strong growth in high-end smartphone shipments.



Apple's shipments in the second quarter were impacted by a combination of factors, including macroeconomic variables, increased competition from new smartphone offerings and delayed purchasing among consumers who are waiting for the next iPhone model. All this led to a build-up of channel inventory, resulting in lower-than-expected iPhone sales.

While the other smartphone companies disclose exact shipment numbers for overall cell phone and smartphone sales, Samsung does not provide precise figures, instead offering general guidance. Because of this, the Samsung cell phone and smartphone shipment numbers indicated here are estimated, and may differ from the interpretations of others.

Near field communication: A potential threat to Android!

Near field communication (NFC), a new radio communications technology, which connects similar smartphones when they are touched or brought close to each other, is already in use in several high end smartphones. This could be a potential threat to Android and Nokia phones.

Charlie Miller, a security specialist at the Black Hat information security conference in Las Vegas, used NFC to transfer malicious code to different smartphones without interacting with the smartphone owner.

Miller studied the process of infecting phones via NFC for about nine months, and focused on applications that use the radio interface like Google's Beam. The demonstration also revealed that a majority of Android devices are outdated and are very vulnerable to this bug, which can infect devices without any user interactions, but by using NFC technology.

With the ever expanding horizons of technology, data security remains a prime concern that needs to be addressed before deploying a large scale technological solution.

Steam for Linux games 'unethical': Stallman

Linux enthusiasts all over the world are happy about the games company, Steam, warming up to Linux, but it has not impressed the founder of GNU. Richard Stallman has expressed his concerns on his blog. Stallman said that while the availability of popular non-free programs on GNU/Linux can boost adoption of the system, it may not bring enough freedom. He writes: "However, our goal goes beyond making this system a 'success'; its purpose is to bring freedom to the users. Thus, the question is how this development affects users' freedom."



Huawei introduces USB dongles

Mobile data cards and USB sticks are gaining popularity rapidly in India as laptop and tablet usage is heading north. One of the key difficulties faced by consumers while shifting from one Internet service provider to another is unlocking their USB dongles. Huawei Devices-India, which makes dongles for telcos like Airtel, Reliance, MTS and Tata Photon, has addressed this problem by introducing the range of open market USB dongles, which can connect you to the Internet, irrespective of your service provider.



Huawei has recently launched the E303 Hi-Link USB dongle and the E355 Wi-Fi dongle that can provide Internet connection to five users at a time. The E303 Hi-Link is priced at Rs 2,199, while the E355 Wi-Fi dongle is available at Rs 5,499.

Huawei HiLink claims to be the world's most advanced data card technology till date with multiple Huawei patents. It can connect users automatically to the Internet within 15 seconds after the datacard is inserted into the USB port, without the need for a tedious dial-in process, driver installation or manual configuration, boasts the company. Users can also store data up to 32 GB via a MicroSD card in the dongle, as a card slot is provided.